

ROLE MODEL

VANNEVAR BUSH

Vannevar Bush was born on March 11, 1890, in Everett, Massachusetts, in a family of the Universalist minister—the Reverend Richard Perry Bush of Provincetown, MA, and Emma Linwood (Paine) Bush. Vannevar had two sisters. As a child, he was sickly and was occasionally bedridden for long periods of time. Still, he was self-confident and sometimes got into fights with other boys. He once said, "all of my recent ancestors [before my father] were sea captains, and they have a way of running things without any doubt. So it may have been partly that, and partly my association with my grandfather, who was a whaling skipper. That left me with some inclination to run a show once I was in it."

Bush did well in the primary school, where he showed an aptitude for math and a love to tinker. Later his father became a pastor at Chelsea, MA, where Vannevar attended the high school. At he same time he has a versatile workshop in his home. After graduation, he went off to *Tufts College* to study engineering. Half of his expenses were paid by a scholarship, to pay the other half, he worked as a tutor and aid in the math department. Vannevar studied earnestly and earned a master›s degree in the time it usually takes to earn a bachelor›s degree. In 1913 he graduated the college as M. S. and went to work for *General Electric*, testing electrical equipment. In 1914-1915 Bush went to taught mathematics at Jackson College.

In 1915 he entered the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) electrical engineering program. Spurred by the need for enough financial security to marry, Bush finished his thesis in less than a year. On 5th of September, 1916, he married at Chelsea, to Phoebe Davis, a Chelsea girl, whom he had known since Tufts. The family had two sons: Richard Davis Bush and John Hathaway Bush. At the end of the same 1916 he had earned a Doctor if Engineering degree (from MIT and Harvard University, jointly) and became an assistant professor of electrical engineering at Tufts.

While at Tufts Bush enjoyed his first experience as an inventor, securing a patent for a device for land surveying,